

Vertigo!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 661 October 2003 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club soirees are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings, run by charming political pundit extraordinaire Nigel Roberts, start at 8.00 pm with club business. Talks commence at 8.01 pm.



Section night: October 6th:

Lydia Bradey: Hold your breath!

The first woman to climb Mt Everest without supplementary oxygen will give us an insight into why people have found Mongolia such a beautiful destination.

Plus...Mongolian world music surprise...need we say more!



The end, AIC 2003 at Taharangi Lodge, Mt Taranaki



Section nights: Upcoming:

November: Phil Castle

Yep, they named Castle Hill and Castle Rock after this guy! Tales of some serious rock climbing action in Patagonia (the region, kiddies, not the clothes) and other exotic parts like El Capitan, Bhagirathi III in India, yadda, yadda.



Section trips news: *Growing and sowing*

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories, tall or short, fat or thin, sharp or dim. We love to know what you're up to!

Weird scenes in the underworld

Maybe some of the people who have seen me swanning (stumbling) around on the AIC recently will find this amusing, but I am conducting the next concert of the Orpheus Choir and Wellington Sinfonia. It's at Wellington Cathedral Molesworth Street on Saturday 18th October at 8pm. The programme is all American music: Barber, Hovhaness and John Adams. Tickets are from Ticketek.

I'd love it if some people from the club were there. There's no way to self-arrest when the orchestra makes a slip...

Simon Romanos

Skiing

Kevin Patterson, Chris Fleck and I had a great weekend based at Whangaehu Hut. The walk up to the hut on Friday night was dubbed "mikes midnight marathon", which I thought was unfair because the distance was closer to six miles than twenty-six (it was a lovely night for a trot though).

On the Saturday we skinned up the Whangaehu Glacier in nice weather, which deteriorated to a white out as we made the top of Pare. After a run from the summit in a brief clearance and a bite to eat at the dome it became obvious that no further clearances could be expected. It was decided that a tactical retreat to the hut was in order. After leading Kevin and Chris on a traverse into the white void I assured them that before us lay the wide and obstacle free glacier, they were firmly instructed to forget the white-out and let rip. After an uncertain start, the confidence built and at one rest stop Kevin informed us that according to his GPS we were averaging 45km/h even though we couldn't see a thing!

Sunday was a glorious day; we skinned up the crater outlet stream and had elevenses at the lake edge. We had a few runs on a choice slope above the lake, and then had a run down the Mangaturuturu Glacier. After a long skin back up the Mangatututuru and across the plateau we enjoyed a brief luncheon in the sun before skiing down the Mangatoetoenui Glacier and traversing around to the hut. After collecting our gear the run back to the car park completed an enjoyable weekend.

Mike Peat

Cordillera Blanca

In July Jon Terry, Bruce Roberts and I went to the Cordillera (sp?) Blanca in Peru. My overall impression that it is hard work doing 5 mountaineering trips in a row. Next holiday I'm going to a beach hah.

Great spot though. It was a mixed bag of results, did three relatively easy peaks at around the 5700m mark (Pisco, Urus, Vallunaraju) but had some bad luck on the two bigger ones. On Alpamayo (5970m) we watched a big serac fall that took out 8 people on the Ferrari route, no shit. We were lucky that we'd decided to have a rest day due to the high number of folks on the climb. Those thinking of climbing this route should be aware of the high level of objective danger despite its popularity and number of successful ascents. Also there are no choppers or radios to speak of in the 'Blanca. Buyer beware. We participated in an attempted rescue of a survivor and didn't feel much like climbing after that.

But we did climb after that: we tried Artensonraju (the Paramount Pictures peak 6025m). Unfortunately the bad luck continued and this was a write-off. We argued with the porters, I stepped in a puddle, and got very ill on bad water despite nuking everything with chlorine or iodine. Never mind, this is one that's worth going back for.

Not sure about these overseas mountaineering trips, the stakes seemed high and the chances of success low. But maybe that's just our bad luck. Mountaineering is mostly punishment and we got our share. I highly recommend this area and I'd go back, but take double the amount of time.

Tom Wilson

NZAJ gets the best stories!

I, Rhys Barrier and James Wright from the Auckland section, went rock climbing in the Magaliesberg in South Africa as a warm up for a trip to Mt Kenya from whence we've just returned - it was a very eventful trip - read all about it in the NZAC journal.

Anj Pande



Our website

- Check out our web site: www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz !
- Join the email discussion group!
- New photos and trip reports up!



New Vertigo editor announced

Rachael Schmidt will be taking over as editor starting with the November edition of Vertigo. I want to thank all of those who have sent material in the Vertigo over the years – you know who you are – Vertigo would not work without you.

Please keep all this good material coming – Rachael, as much as me, needs all those trip reports, information, events information, notices, and equipment ads that YOU as the collective reader can possibly send in – all the things that make members actually read their newsletter and feel part of a climbing community.

I have enjoyed the work immensely. I wish Rachael luck in putting her own unique stamp on things.

Simon



MOVED HOUSE?

Tell:

Richard Wesley, NZAC Administrator
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595, FAX (03) 337 7594
e mail office@alpineclub.org.nz



Rust put to sleep at Titahi Bay by grand coalition of forces!

After six years of bitching about the state of the tracks with the disgusting car wrecks etc at Titahi Bay (Whitereia Park) - something is finally happening. DOC, Hang Dog climbing, and the NZ Air Force (supplying the helicopters) have got together and now the wrecks are all going to be removed within the next 6 weeks. And later the tracks will be upgraded as well.

Finally we will be able to access the rock (and take visitors without cringing) without having to walk past the eyesores.

Good news indeed.

by Warwick, Hang Dog



CHAIRPERSON'S QUIZ No. 4: Answer

King Albert the First of Belgium was the monarch who was killed in a rock-climbing accident. He fell to his death during a solo climb in February 1934.

Four correct entries were received, and as a result of a live draw before the short talks at the September section night meeting, Dieter Ayers won a bottle of wine. In keeping with the royal theme, it was Queen Adelaide wine...



CHAIRPERSON'S 5th QUIZ

Nigel Roberts claims that his fascination with the upper classes is logical - after all, he says, climbers aim for the top. It clearly continues unabated, because Nigel's 5th quiz question is:-

Prince Luigi Amadeo is closely associated with mountain ranges on three continents in addition to mountains on the continent he came from. Which three mountain ranges are they? What is the basis for Prince Luigi's claim to fame in each of the three ranges?

Email your answers -- with the words "Quiz number 5" in the subject line -- to chairperson@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz by no later than 5:00 pm on Sunday, 5 October, to be in with a chance of winning a bottle of wine from Prince Luigi's homeland. (Unlike Powerball, the chairperson's prizes do not jackpot. If there are no correct answers, Nigel plans to drink the wine himself.)

Do you have a great photo?

Good enough for the cover of vertiGO? The send it to:
cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



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Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
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Family social climbing mooted

Interest has been expressed in the section organising small family group trips of a climbing nature. Ideas have included Wharepapa and Whanganui Bay Rock weekends, Castle Hill meet, Unwin hut meet in school hols (one week say), Payne's Ford, even some tramps perhaps.

If you are interested in this idea please let me know and if there is enough interest we will develop a plan of action so people can get together to enjoy climbing as a family experience. Contact me at sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Steve Hart



NZAC National Instruction Programme

Course Numbers are limited so book early! Fully qualified alpine guides or rock instructors will be used to lead all courses and there will be an instructor - student ration of 1:4 ensuring an excellent learning environment.

Intermediate Rock Instruction (Two Days) \$99

23-24 October, Otago

1-2 November, Canterbury

23-24 October, Auckland

1-2 November, Wellington

Intermediate-Advanced Mountaineering (Five Days) \$950

3-7 January 2004, Unwin Hut Mt Cook

10-14 January 2004 Unwin Hut Mt Cook

Richard Wesley

National Administrator

Phone: 03 377 7595

Email: richard@alpineclub.org.nz



39 Mercer Street, PO Box 1560, Wellington, New Zealand
Ph/Fax (04) 4735353 email mainly.tramping@paradise.net.nz

And here are the club trips...

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to Mike Williams (trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email me, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and I can help you get going on a safe and enjoyable trip.

See you in the hills!

Trips currently on the calendar...

Wharepapa Rock Climbing	<i>Weekend October 4-5 (note change)</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend away rock climbing at Wharepapa in the central North Island.	

Arthurs Pass / Castle Hill Exploration	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock / Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A trip with everything, the plan involves a mix of rock climbing at Castle Hill and Flock Hill, and day trips with mountaineering objectives such as Rolleston, Phipps, or possibly a 2 dayer to Franklin. Details depend on ambitions and abilities in the group. Trip to be based at NZAC hut in Arthurs Pass Village.	

Aoraki / Mt Cook National Park	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Kevin Patterson userkev1@netscape.net	
An extended long weekend, probably involving one day off work, with the aim of climbing either Mt Dixon from the Plateau area, or the Minarets, from the Tasman Valley. For 2 days leave get a 5 day long weekend in Grand Plateau, the number one climbing area of New Zealand. This is your chance to experience a stunningly glaciated area surrounded by 3000m peaks! The primary aim is to climb Mt Dixon a relatively straightforward Grade 2 peak. Other peaks could include Silberhorn and Lendenfeld. Get in soon as places are very limited. Participants need to be AIC trained with 3 other completed alpine climbs. Participants do NOT have to be extremely fit as I will only be moving at a medium pace! See http://www.geocities.com/kevin_patterson1/cook.html for details.	

Paynes Ford	<i>Weekend November 8-9</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend to the top-o-the-south, rock climbing at Paynes Ford.	

Tasman Saddle	<i>Week November 29- December 7</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Caroline Duggan, email cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
Garth London, email gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
Already full! If interested get your name on the waiting list soon!	

Hopkins Valley	<i>Week January 3 – 11, 2004</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering / Rock	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A week away from the tourist hoards, exploring this great area just south of Cook/Aoraki, with tramping and easy summits through to cragging and snowy mountains.	

Taranaki Rock Trip	<i>Long weekend January 17-18-19</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> TBC email rocktrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	

Nepal	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas Expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
How about a slightly longer trip to Nepal in Oct/Nov 2004? *Update* : Interest steadily grows. With the changing regulations so too do the objectives, one of which is to scale Mt Have-a-Good-Time. Trekking options will be part of this trip. We'll be aiming to stay away from the Everest circus while still utilising the ease of logistics. One of our goals will be an unclimbed peak up to 6500m. If you are interested and willing to be part of a team effort contact Steve.	

Chile	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas Expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Toto Gronlund, toto.high@ntl-world.com	
The English alpine club are organising a trip to Patagonia in 2004.	



HANGDOG INDOOR CLIMBING CAVERN

Come down and see us for all your climbing and bouldering needs. We have heaps of good routes from grade 14 through to 30. We have the only bouldering room in Wellington, which we have just enlarged to help aspiring and existing climbers become STRONGER.

Remember that it only costs NZAC members \$8.00 to climb with ID, and you get 20% off all climbing gear that you purchase from us. If we don't have what you want we will get it.

HangDog and Top Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181



For sale...wanted...climber partner needed

For sale: Leather mountaineering boots - can be worn with clip on crampons.

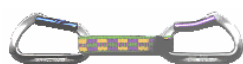
One pair size 41, one pair size 46. \$350 each pair ono. And there's a story behind them! Both pairs have been worn for one trip only – but on a 68 day trip up Mt Kenya. We had to buy them mail order hence didn't get the sizings exactly right and we ended up with them too big. Both pairs of boots are in good condition. These boots fall out smaller than the regular sizings - the size 41s would probably fit you if you normally wear a 39 (roughly a 6 or 7). The 46 would fit if you normally wear about a size 11-11 1/2. Phone Anjali on 04 4753 285 or 025 247 1961.

WANTED: Plastic mountaineering boots in good condition, all sizes.

Phone Kate or Mike on 03 7534 099, PO Box 4, Franz Josef Glacier, South Westland. Phone 03 7534 099, e-mail westcoastclimbing@xtra.co.nz.

Ski tour or climbing partner wanted!: 6th - 31st Oct for short or long trips. 8 years climbing experience and now trying my hand at ski touring. Please leave a message with contact number. Steve (Christchurch) 03 3775034, steven_jeff@yahoo.com





Wellington Section Directory: 2003 contact list

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office. You can contact:

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron	Judy Reid	N/A	N/A
Chairperson	Nigel Roberts	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> NR	(04) 475 7543
Vice Chairpersons	Pete De Joux	PDJ <i>or</i> PD	(04) 478 1017
	Steve Hart	SH	N/A
Secretary	Rachael Schmidt	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RS	(04) 470 4479
Treasurer	Caroline Duggan	TREASURER <i>or</i> CD	(04) 475 5542
National Representative	Caroline Duggan	CD	(04) 475 5542
	Nigel Roberts	NR	(04) 475 7543
Instruction: AIC	Pete de Joux	AIC	(04) 478 1017
Instruction: RIC	Scott Taylor	SPRINGROCK	N/A
Trips	Mike Williams	TRIPS <i>or</i> MW	(04) 973 2995
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Lynn Ayers	LA	(04) 977 4914
	Michele Domaneschi	MD	N/A
	Garth London	GL	(04) 479 2984
	Alan Lowrie	AL	N/A
	Mike O'Brien	MOB	(04) 380 0913
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
	Mike Williams	MW	(04) 973 2995
National President	Dave Bamford	DB	N/A
Palmerston North Contact	John Barnes	JB	(06) 357 0654
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	RS	(04) 470 4479
Section Night Admin	Kara Lipski	KL	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

